BISHOP STUART UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF AGRICULTURE, ENVIRONMENTAL SIENCES AND TECHNOLOGY

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTING, LIBRARY, INFORMATION AND TECHNOLOGY

GROUP 6

S/NO	NAME	REG/NO
1	MBABAZI ALVIN	24/BSU/DIT/3253
2	KANSIIME ANDREW	24/BSU/DCS/1450
3	NYESIGAMUKAMA AUGUSTINE	24/BSU/DIT/1554
4	BEGUMYA ZION	24/BSU/DIT/1423
5	AKANKWATSA BRINTON	24/BSU/DIT/2916
6	ARINDA BERNADINE TUSIIME	24/BSU/DCS/0758

BedSpace

Student Housing Finder for Bishop Stuart University

GROUP 6 Project Concept Document | BSU, Mbarara, Uganda

1. Problem Statement

Finding affordable, safe and verified housing near Bishop Stuart University (BSU) in Mbarara is a frustrating experience for most students usually at the beginning of semesters. The current process is entirely informal students rely on word of mouth, “gamba nogu” schemes on campus or scattered social media posts in WhatsApp groups. This leads to:

- Students arriving on campus with no confirmed accommodation.
- Landlords with available rooms struggling to reach the right tenants.
- No way to verify room quality, pricing or landlord credibility before visiting.
- Exploitation of first-year and out-of-town students by unverified agents.
- Insecure accommodations risking lives of the students or even lecturers.
- Accommodation regret

BedSpace solves this by creating a structured, web-based platform where BSU students and verified landlords connect directly; saving time, reducing risk and bringing transparency to student and lecture housing in Mbarara.

2. About BedSpace

BedSpace is a web application designed specifically for Bishop Stuart University students and property owners in the Mbarara area at large. It serves as a trusted digital directory where landlords list available rooms and students search, compare and contact landlords directly all in one place.

The platform operates across three distinct user roles:

Role	Who They Are	Primary Action
Student	BSU students seeking housing.	Search, view, save and contact landlords.
Landlord	Property owners near BSU campus and Mbarara are at large	List, manage, and update room availability
Admin	Platform manager / BSU representative	Verify listings, manage users, maintain platform

3. Target Audience

Primary Users Students.

BSU students, particularly first-year and out-of-town students who arrive in Mbarara without pre-arranged accommodation. This group is most vulnerable to housing exploitation and benefits most from a verified, searchable listing platform.

Secondary Users Landlords & Property Owners.

Individuals and families owning rental properties, single rooms or ***"bedspaces"*** within at atleast 3 to 5 km radius of BSU campus. Many currently rely on informal networks to find tenants. "BedSpace" gives them a digital storefront at no barrier.

Tertiary Users - University Administration.

BSU welfare and student services departments can use the admin dashboard to monitor listed accommodation standards, flag unsafe listings and guide students toward verified options.

4. Core Features

	Feature	Description
1	**User Registration & Login**	Secure sign-up and login for Students and Landlords with password hashing. Separate dashboards per role.
2	**Property Listing (CRUD)**	Landlords can Create, Read, Update and Delete their property listings including photos, price and amenities.
3	**Search & Filter**	Students search listings by price range, room type (bedspace / single / double), proximity to BSU and availability.
4	**Property Detail Page**	Each listing has a full-page view with photos, description, location, price, and landlord contact and availability status.
5	**Booking / Contact Request**	Students submit a contact request to a landlord. Landlords view and respond through their dashboard.
6	**Reviews & Ratings**	Verified students who have stayed at a property can leave a rating and short review, building trust over time.
7	**Saved Listings**	Students can save/bookmark listings to compare later from their personal dashboard.
8	**Admin Dashboard**	Admins verify new landlord accounts, review flagged listings, manage users and view platform activity.

5. Technology Stack

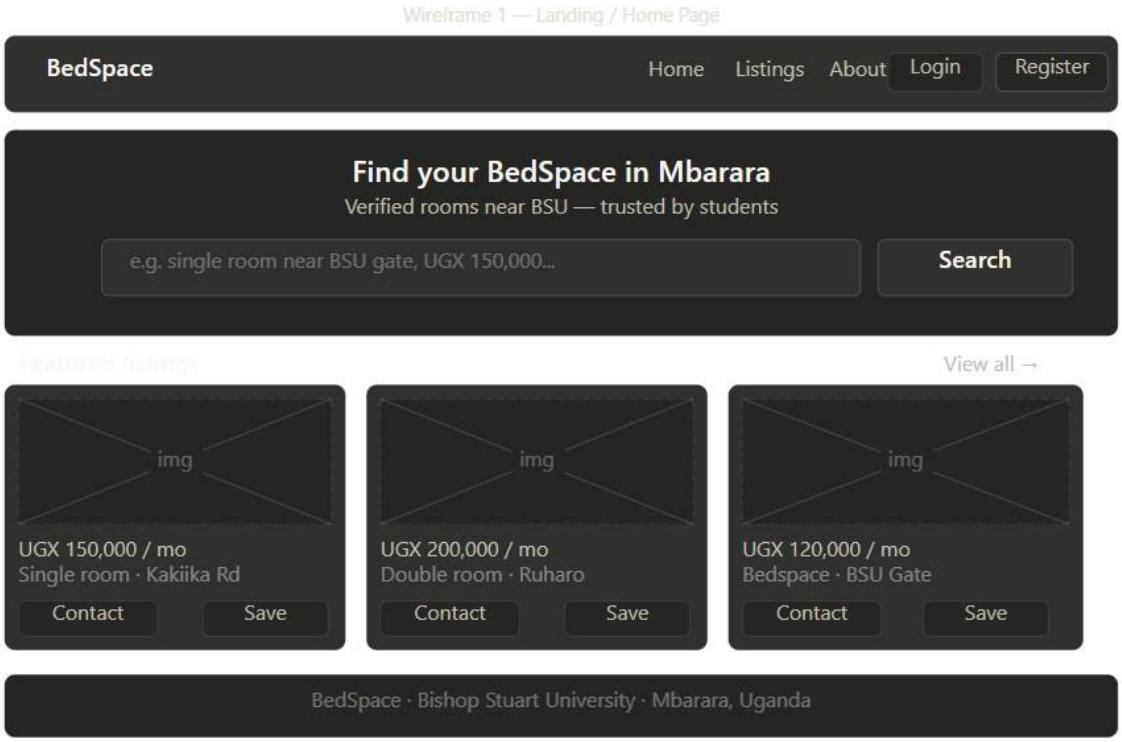
Layer	Technology
Frontend	HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript
Backend	PHP (procedural / OOP)
Database	MySQL (MariaDB)
Version Control	Git & GitHub (collaborative branching per feature)
Server / Hosting	XAMPP (local)

6. Sitemap Web Pages.

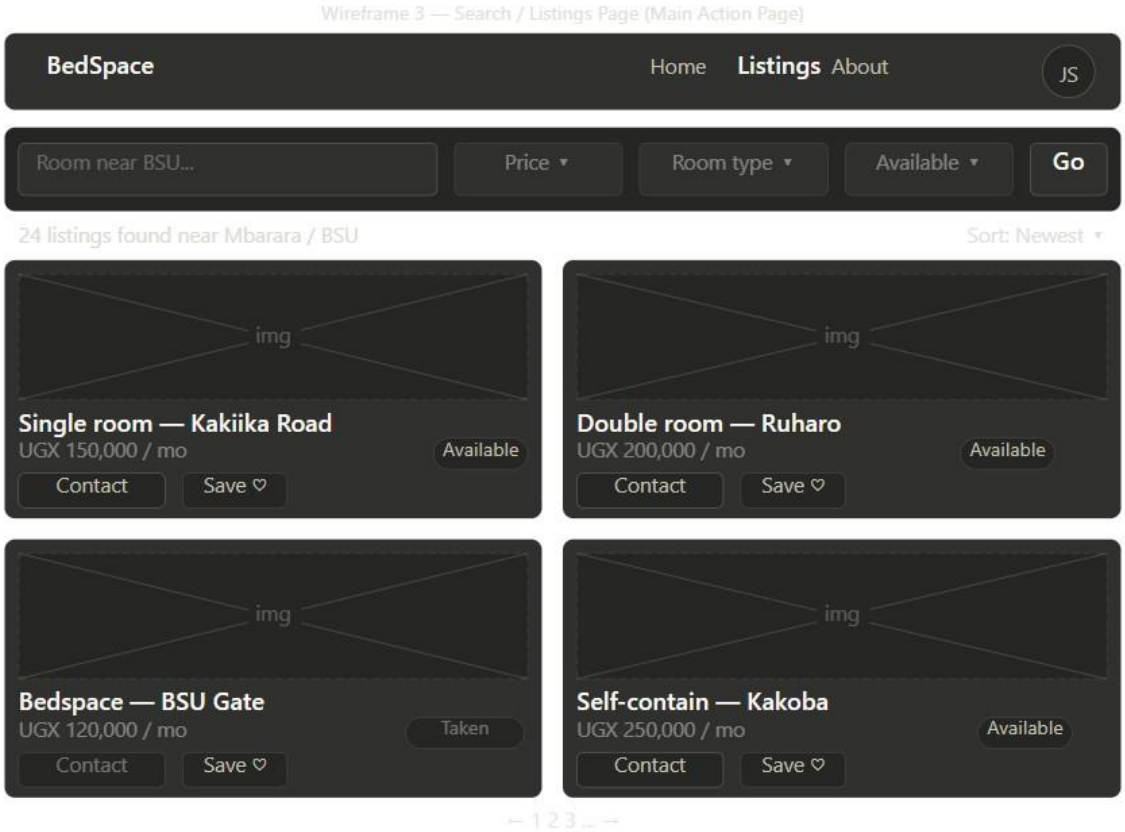
BedSpace consists of the following web pages:

- ✓ ***Home / Landing Page:*** Introduction, search bar, featured listings, call-to-action buttons.
- ✓ ***Register / Login Page:*** Unified auth page with role selection (Student / Landlord)
- ✓ ***Listings Page:*** Searchable, filterable directory of all available properties.
- ✓ ***Property Detail Page:*** Full info on a single listing: photos, price, amenities, landlord contact.
- ✓ ***Student Dashboard:*** Saved listings, contact requests sent, profile management.
- ✓ ***Landlord Dashboard:*** Manage property listings (add/edit/delete), view incoming requests.
- ✓ ***Admin Dashboard:*** User management, listing verification, flagged content, platform stats.
- ✓ ***About / Contact Page:*** Project info, BSU context, support contact form

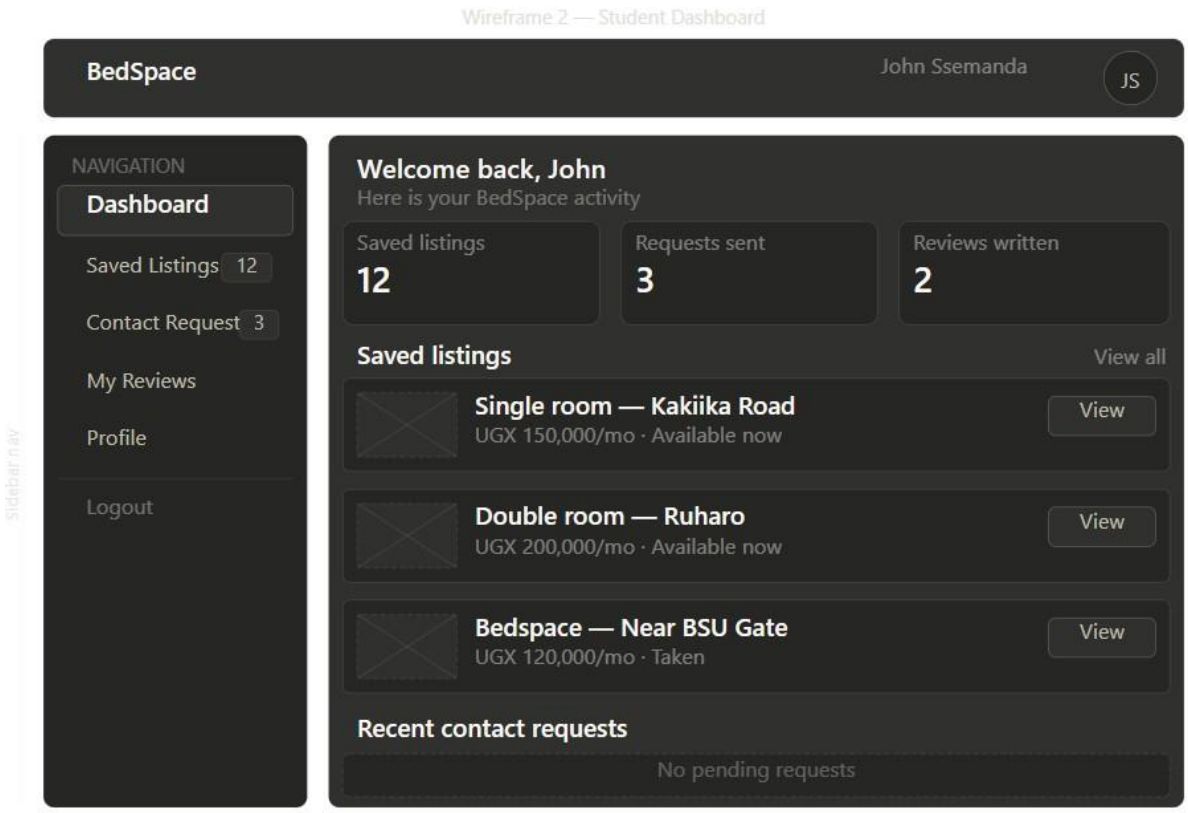
7. Image Sketches.



Home page imagery



Listings page



Account listings